



MAASAI

CATTLE HERDERS OF OF EAST AFRICA

THE MAASAI PEOPLE live along the Great Rift Valley in southern Kenya and northern Tanzania. Although they are seminomadic, and traditionally have not cultivated crops, they are tied to the land by their animals. Land



JUMPING COMPETITIONS

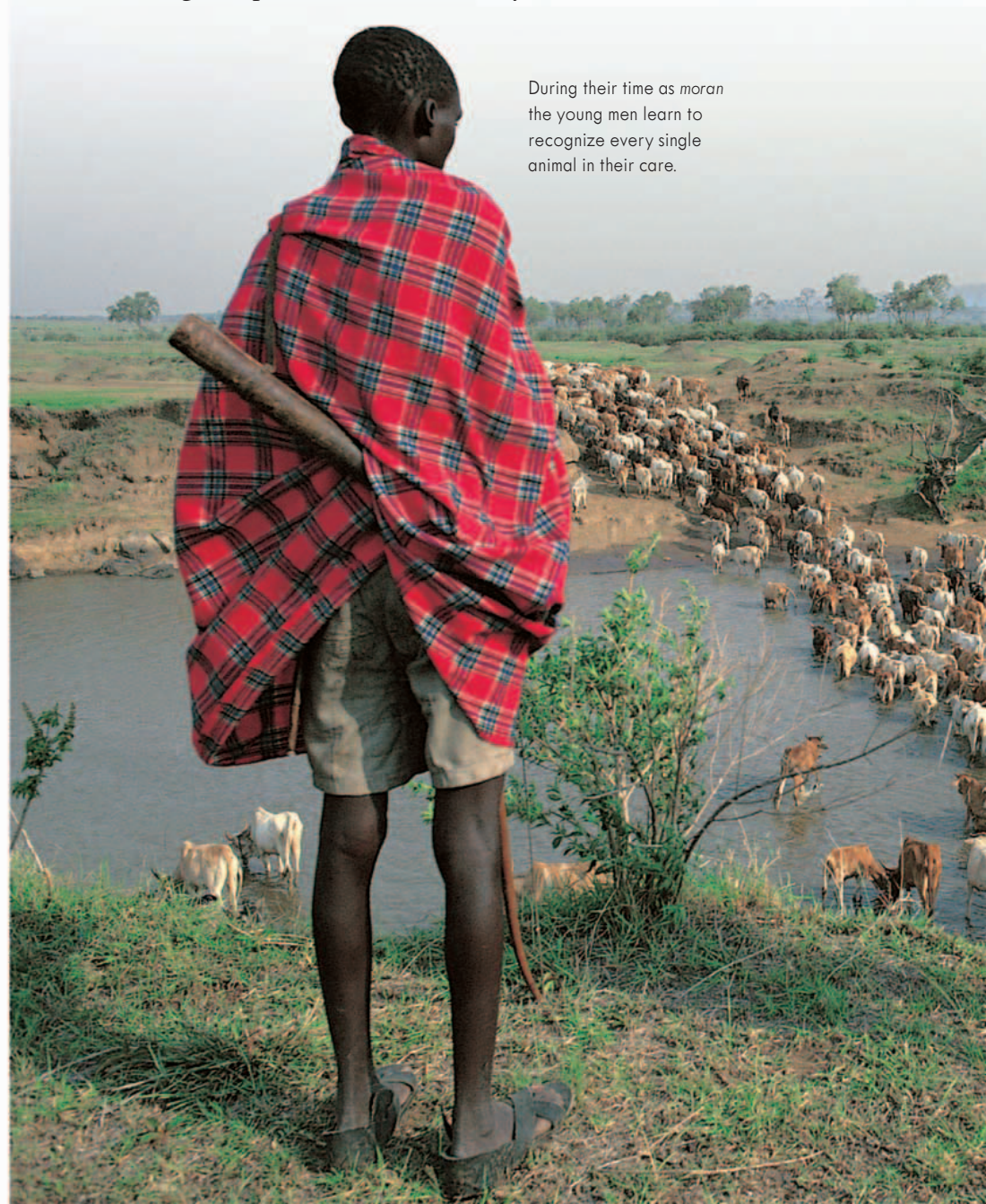
Everyone sings and dances in Maasai ceremonies. *Moran* show their prowess by rhythmic vertical jumping—the higher the better. They can jump for hours, sustained by the singing and chanting of the rest of the group.

HELPING OUT

Maasai children spend most of their time playing, but they are allowed to look after sheep and goats, which are not as highly prized as cattle. They are encouraged to be respectful and to address all elders, not just their own parents, as “mother” or “father.”

Men and cattle

The Maasai way of life revolves around keeping animals, particularly cattle. Maasai men are grouped with their contemporaries into age-sets in which they remain for their entire lives. Particular types of work are allocated to each age-set. Every few years, the entire age-set participates in a ceremony at which they move up a stage. Young men between their late teens and early twenties are *moran*, or warriors. During this period of their lives they live with and look after the cattle.



During their time as *moran* the young men learn to recognize every single animal in their care.